



ANALYST ROLE

Analyst Guide

pktLog v1.0 · Search · Investigate · Export · Alert Review

Role Overview

The **Analyst** role provides full read access to all log data plus the ability to search, filter, export results, and manage alert events. Analysts are the primary users for incident investigation, compliance evidence collection, and day-to-day security monitoring.

Analysts **cannot** modify platform configuration, manage users, or change ingest/alert settings.

Dashboard

The Dashboard shows the live state of all syslog ingestion. Key widgets:

Widget	Description
Events/sec	Current live ingest rate
Events Today	Total events since midnight
Severity Breakdown	Distribution across emergency→debug
Volume Timeseries	Event volume chart — spot spikes
Top Hosts	Most active log sources by count
Active Alerts	Open alert events needing review
Collector Status	Last-seen timestamps per collector

Use the **time-range selector** at the top to adjust all widgets simultaneously.

Log Explorer

Navigate to: Logs

The Log Explorer is your primary investigation tool. It provides paginated access to all stored syslog events with rich filtering and row detail expansion.

Log Table Columns

Column	Description
Timestamp	Event time (from syslog message)
Received At	Server arrival time (reliable even with bad device clocks)
Host	Source device hostname or IP
Severity	Color-coded badge (Emergency → Debug)
Facility	Syslog facility (kern, auth, daemon, etc.)
Program	Application/process name
Message	Message body — click to expand full detail
Site / Collector	Enrichment from collector registry

Click any row to expand the detail panel, which shows all 17 normalized fields including `raw_message` (the original unmodified syslog line).

Search & Filters

Filters are additive (AND logic). All filters apply simultaneously.

Filter	Values
Time Range	Last 15m, 1h, 6h, 24h, 7d, or custom start/end
Host	Exact or wildcard match
Severity	Multi-select one or more severity levels
Facility	kern, auth, daemon, local0–local7, etc.
Program	Application name (sshd, nginx, cron, etc.)
Site	From collector registry
Keyword	Full-text search in message field — supports regex
Collector	By registered collector IP or name

Quick investigation tip: Combine **Severity: error+critical+emergency** with a **short time window** to rapidly surface all high-priority events during an incident.

Exporting Data

Apply filters in the Log Explorer, then click **Export**. Choose:

- **CSV** — best for spreadsheet analysis, pivot tables, reports
- **JSON** — best for programmatic processing, SIEM import, scripting

Exports include all 17 normalized fields: `received_at`, `event_time`, `host`, `severity`, `facility`, `priority`, `program`, `pid`, `message`, `raw_message`, `collector_ip`, `collector_name`, `site`, `group_name`, `msg_id`, `structured_data`, `ingest_id`.

Alert Review

Navigate to: Alerts → Events

State	Meaning	Your Action
Open	Fired, not reviewed	Investigate, then acknowledge or resolve
Acknowledged	Under investigation	Resolve when the condition is cleared
Resolved	Investigation complete	No action needed

Click any alert to see the detail panel including the triggering rule, the time window, and a direct link to search the Log Explorer for the relevant events.

Common Investigation Workflows

Security Incident

1. Open **Logs** → set time range to the incident window
2. Filter: **Severity = error + critical + emergency**
3. Add **Host** filter if the affected device is known
4. Use **Keyword Search** for terms like "denied", "failed", "unauthorized"
5. Expand rows to view all structured fields and `raw_message`
6. **Export** filtered results as CSV/JSON for the incident report

Checking a Specific Device

Set **Host** to the device name/IP, select a **24h** window. Review volume spikes in the timeseries, then drill into the time bucket of interest.

Compliance Evidence

Filter: **Facility = auth, Program = sshd** (or your auth daemon), desired date range. Export as CSV. The `raw_message` field provides the unmodified syslog line for audit trail purposes.

Baseline Review

Leave filters open except for a **7-day** window. Review the severity distribution chart and top-hosts list to establish what normal looks like before investigating deviations.